

Chapter

Lakshmi and Vishnu — The Principle That Sustains Life



Introduction: Creation, Sustenance and Ending

The Sanatan tradition speaks of three works of the cosmos: **creation** (utpatti), **sustenance** (paalan) and **ending** (dissolution). Creation is associated with Brahma and Saraswati, sustenance with Vishnu and Lakshmi, and ending with Kali-Mahakali. In this short discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji raises a simple yet profound question: in which of these

three is most of our life spent? The answer also reveals why Sanatan Dharma gives Mahalakshmi such great importance.

How Long Does the Moment of Creation Last?

Acharya Ji begins with our own birth:

"When you come into being, that is, when you are born — that moment, the moment of creation — that is when you were created, right? How many minutes did that moment last in your life?"

And likewise the moment of death:

"Death too will come one day, when one departs — how many minutes will that moment last? A few milliseconds."

Birth is the event of an instant; after it we are simply **living**:

"After being born, from the second moment on, you are born. So how long was that moment of being born?"

The same holds true for relationships. Acharya Ji says, lightly:

"In the beginning you saw a girl, looked into her eyes, and there was love at first sight. Then there is a second sight, a third sight too, isn't there — it carries on. And the first sight was over — how many seconds did it take? That is the creation."

"After that, some feeling must have arisen within — that too happened for the first time. What came from the second time on — what was that?"

And to business as well:

"You want to start a business — you applied the papers, did some registration, and the beginning is over. Ending doesn't take time either, nor does beginning."

The conclusion is clear:

"The moment of creation is very short."

Most of the Time Goes to Sustenance

Now Acharya Ji poses the central question:

"So for most of the time, will you need Brahma and Saraswati, or will you need Kali-Mahakali, or will you need Vishnu-Lakshmi?"

And he answers:

"**Most of the time goes to sustenance.** Whether it is of the body, whether it is of a business, whatever you talk about — yes, running a kingdom, anything at all, go to any level, run a family — you will require Lakshmi tattva and Vishnu tattva a lot."

Tattva here means the root power or principle that is expressed in the form of a deity. **Vishnu tattva** is the principle of sustaining and protecting, and **Lakshmi tattva** is the prosperity and power of resources without which nothing can be sustained. Body, family, business or kingdom — keeping going what has already come into being is the longest work of life.

Small Creations Within the Larger Story

But this does not mean that the work of Brahma and Saraswati ends with birth. Acharya Ji cautions:

"Along the way, we cannot forget that Brahma is also there. Not just for one second — **in every moment something or other, new, new, new, keeps being created.**"

The example of business once more:

"Earlier, when there was a small branch or just a starting, that is when it was created. Now I will open a second branch, I will open a new unit, I will appoint someone new. So that too is new — within the big there are small, small creations."

And of life:

"You were born — just as you were. Then from a small child you grow a little bigger, then you have to go to school — something new is created, meaning from there something new in life has begun. Once again you are going to need Saraswati."

Every new beginning also has an end. Acharya Ji says with humour:

"School should end at some point, shouldn't it? Or will you keep studying your whole life? Age of 72, and what are you doing? Fourth-grade class is going on!"

Therefore:

"In the big story, small things keep being created again and coming to an end. So this does not mean that Kali and Saraswati are not needed now at all. In between, new, new, new cycles will keep coming."

Marriage: A New Chapter of Life

Marriage too is such a creation — a new world between life's main beginning and main end:

"Between your main creation and your main end, didn't one more new chapter come into being? Something new was created. To do that work, once again a new Saraswati, everything new — Brahma will be needed. From there a **new world will be built**, and for that, intelligence again."

And whatever is created is certain to end one day — whatever form that takes:

"At some point it will end — either with your death, or with a quarrel, or in some accident, or anything at all — attaining a hero's death, there will be a war — anything, it can happen any way. Or for work, the two had to go to two different places."

"We don't know how it will be. But one day, at some point — it may be with the death of the body. One person may go first, but the other still lives on, right?"

Therefore Mahalakshmi Is Supreme

What Acharya Ji wants to convey through all these examples is that all three powers are needed again and again in life:

"In between, some new business will start again, so you cannot tell that right now I don't need Saraswati, I don't need Kali right now."

But in every story, small or big, the longest part is sustenance:

"In the big story there are small, small, small stories. But even so, in that small story too, whatever was created — what will be needed to maintain it along the way? **Once again, that Vishnu and that Lakshmi.**"

And this is the reason:

"That is why in our Sanatan Dharma, Mahalakshmi has been given the greatest importance."

Summary: Key Takeaways

- 1 Creation and ending last but a moment** — birth, death, the start of a relationship or a business all happen in an instant.
- 2 Most of life is spent in sustenance** — keeping anything going, whether body, family, business or kingdom, requires Vishnu tattva and Lakshmi tattva a great deal.
- 3 Small stories keep unfolding within the big story** — school, marriage, a new branch: every new beginning needs Brahma-Saraswati again, and every closing needs Kali.
- 4 No one can say they do not need one of these powers** — new cycles will keep arriving in between.
- 5 That is why Sanatan Dharma gives Mahalakshmi the greatest importance** — for she is the power that keeps everything that has been created in being.